Engineering Mathematics

Kee-Youn Yoo

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1 Introduction to Differential Equations

1.1 Definitions and Terminology

- A **differential equation (DE)** is an equation containing the **derivatives** of **one or more dependent variables** with respect to **one or more independent variables**
- Notation
  - Leibniz notation $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$
  - Prime notation y''
  - Newton's dot notation $\ddot{y}$
  - Subscript notation $u_{xx} + u_{yy} = 0$

1.1.1 Classification by Type

- **Ordinary differential equation (ODE):** Derivatives are with respect to a single independent variable

$$\frac{dx}{dt} + \frac{dy}{dt} = 3x + 2y$$

- **Partial differential equation (PDE):** Derivatives are with respect to two or more independent variables

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial y} = -\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}$$

1.1.2 Classification by Order

- The order of an ODE or PDE is the order of the highest derivatives in the equation

$$\underbrace{\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}}_{\text{highest order}} + 5\left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)^3 - 4y = e^x$$

$$2\underbrace{\frac{\partial^4 u}{\partial x^4}}_{\text{highest order}} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial t^2} = 0$$

1.1.3 Classification by Linearity

- An n-th order ODE, $F\left(x, y, y', \cdots, y^{(n)}\right) = 0,$ is **linear** in the variable y if F is linear in $y, y', \cdots, y^{(n)}$
- An ODE is **nonlinear** if:
  - The coefficients of $y, y', \cdots, y^{(n)}$ contain the dependent variable y or its derivatives
  - Powers of $y, y', \cdots, y^{(n)}$ appear in the equation *or*
  - Nonlinear functions of the dependent variable or its derivatives (e.g., $\sin y$ or $e^{y'}$) appear in the equation

1.1.4 Solution of an ODE

- Any function ϕ, defined on an interval I and possessing at least n derivatives that are continuous on I, which when substituted into an ODE reduces the equation to an identity, is **a solution**
- Interval I can be an open interval (a, b), a closed interval $[a, b]$, an infinite interval (a, ∞), etc.
- A solution of a differential equation that is identically zero on an interval I is a **trivial solution**
- The graph of a solution ϕ of an ODE is a **solution curve** and it is continuous on its interval I while the domain of ϕ may differ from the interval I
- An **explicit solution** is one in which the dependent variable is expressed solely in terms of the independent variable and constants
- $G(x, y) = 0$ is an **implicit solution**, if at least one function ϕ exists, that satisfies the relation G and the ODE on I

1.1.5 Families of Solutions

- Similar to integration, we obtain a solution to a first-order differential equation containing an arbitrary constant c
- A solution with a constant c represents a set $G(x, y, c) = 0$ of solutions, called a **one-parameter family of solutions**
- An n-parameter family of solutions

$$G(x, y, c_1, c_2, \cdots, c_n) = 0$$

  solves an n-th order differential equation

1.1.6 Systems of Differential Equations

- Two or more equations involving the derivatives of two or more unknown functions of a single independent variable are called the **system of differential equations**

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dx}{dt} &= f(t, x, y) \\ \frac{dy}{dt} &= g(t, x, y) \end{aligned}$$

- A solution of a system is a set of functions defined on a common interval I that satisfies each equation of the system on this interval

1.2 Initial-Value Problems - IVP

In an **IVP**, we seek a solution $y(x)$ of a differential equation so that $y(x)$ satisfies **initial conditions** at x_0

- n-th order differential equation and Initial conditions

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d^n y}{dx^n} &= f\left(x, y, y', \cdots, y^{(n-1)}\right) \\ y(x_0) = y_0,\ y'(x_0) &= y_1, \cdots,\ y^{(n-1)}(x_0) = y_{n-1} \end{aligned}$$

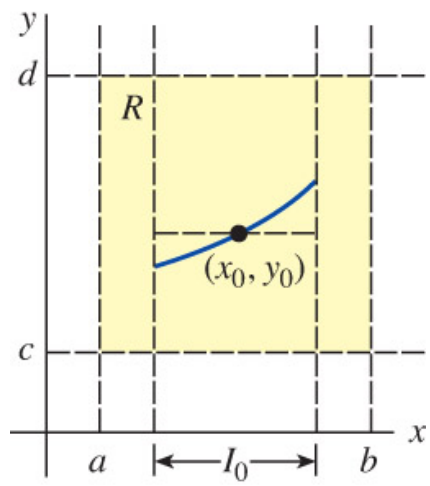
$$\Downarrow$$

$$\frac{d\mathbf{y}}{dx} = \mathbf{f}(x, \mathbf{y}), \quad \mathbf{y} = \mathbf{y}_0$$

When solving an IVP, consider whether a solution exists and whether the solution is unique

- **Existence:** Does the differential equation possess solutions and do any of the solution curves pass through the initial point (x_0, y_0)?
- **Uniqueness:** When can we be certain there is precisely one solution curve passing through the initial point (x_0, y_0)?

Theorem 1.1. *gives conditions that are sufficient to guarantee the existence and uniqueness of a solution $y(x)$ to a first-order IVP*



- $f(x, y)$ *and* $\dfrac{\partial f}{\partial y}$ *are continuous on the region* R *for the interval* I_0

Example First-order IVP

- $y(x) = ce^x$ is a one-parameter family of solutions of the first-order DE $y' = y$
- Find a solution of the first-order IVP with initial condition $y(0) = 3$

Solution

- From the initial condition, we obtain $3 = ce^0$
- Solving, we find $c = 3$
- The solution of the IVP is $y = 3e^x$

Example Second-order IVP

- $x(t) = c_1 \cos 4t + c_2 \sin 4t$ is a two-parameter family of solutions of the second-order DE $x'' + 16x = 0$

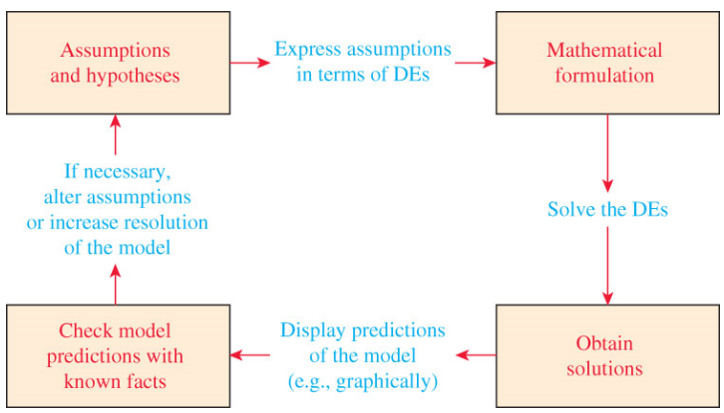
- Find a solution of the second-order IVP with initial conditions $x\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right) = -2,\ x'\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right) = 1$

Solution

- Substituting for initial conditions and solving for constants, we find $c_1 = -2$ and $c_2 = 1/4$
- The solution of the IVP is $x(t) = -2\cos 4t + \frac{1}{4}\sin 4t$

1.3 Differential Equations as Mathematical Models

- A **mathematical model** is a description of a system or a phenomenon
- Differential equation models are used to describe behavior in various fields
  - Biology
  - Chemistry
  - Physics
- Steps of the modeling process



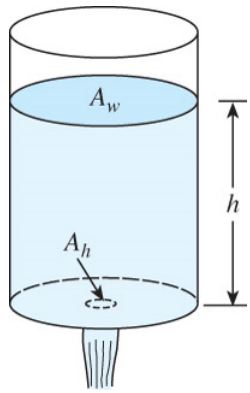
Example Radioactive Decay

- In modeling the phenomenon, it is assumed that the rate $\dfrac{dA}{dt}$ at which the nuclei of a substance decays is proportional to the amount $A(t)$ remaining at time t given an initial amount of radioactive substance on hand A_0

$$\frac{dA}{dt} = -kA,\ A(0) = A_0$$

- This differential equation also describes a first-order chemical reaction

Example Draining Tank



- Toricelli's law states that the exit speed v of water through a sharp-edged hole at the bottom of a tank filled to a depth h is the same as the speed it would acquire falling from a height h, $v = \sqrt{2gh}$
- Volume V leaving the tank per second is proportional to the area of the hole A_h

$$\frac{dV}{dt} = -A_h\sqrt{2gh}$$

- The volume in the tank at t is $V(t) = A_w h$, in which A_w is the *constant* area of the upper water surface
- Combining expressions gives the differential equation for the height of water at time t

$$\frac{dh}{dt} = -\frac{A_h}{A_w}\sqrt{2gh}$$

Worked Exercises

1.2: 1. $y = 1/(1 + c_1 e^{-x})$ is a one-parameter family of solutions of the first-order DE $y' = y - y^2$. Find a solution of the first-order IVP consisting of this differential equation and the given initial condition:

$$y(0) = -\frac{1}{3}$$

Solution

$$
\begin{aligned}
y &= \frac{1}{1+c_1 e^{-x}} \\
&\Downarrow \text{ at } x{=}0 \\
-\frac{1}{3} &= \frac{1}{1+c_1} \\
&\Downarrow \\
c_1 &= -4 \\
&\Downarrow \\
y &= \frac{1}{1-4e^{-x}}
\end{aligned}
$$

1.2: 3. $y = 1/(x^2+c)$ is a one-parameter family of solutions of the first-order DE $y'+2xy^2 = 0$. Find a solution of the first-order IVP consisting of this differential equation and the given initial condition. Give the largest interval I over which the solution is defined

$$
y(2) = \frac{1}{3}
$$

Solution

$$
\begin{aligned}
y &= \frac{1}{x^2+c} \\
&\Downarrow \text{ at } x{=}2 \\
\frac{1}{3} &= \frac{1}{4+c} \\
&\Downarrow \\
c = -1\,, &\quad I = (1, \infty) \\
&\Downarrow \\
y &= \frac{1}{x^2-1}
\end{aligned}
$$

```
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

x = np.linspace(-5, 5, 200)
y = 1.0 /(x**2 -1)

threshold = 20
y[y > threshold] = np.inf
y[y <-threshold] = np.inf
```

```
plt.plot(x,y)
plt.scatter(2, 1/3, color='red')

plt.title(r'$y=\frac{1}{x^2 -1}$')
plt.xlabel('$x$')
plt.ylabel('$y$')
plt.grid()

plt.show()
```

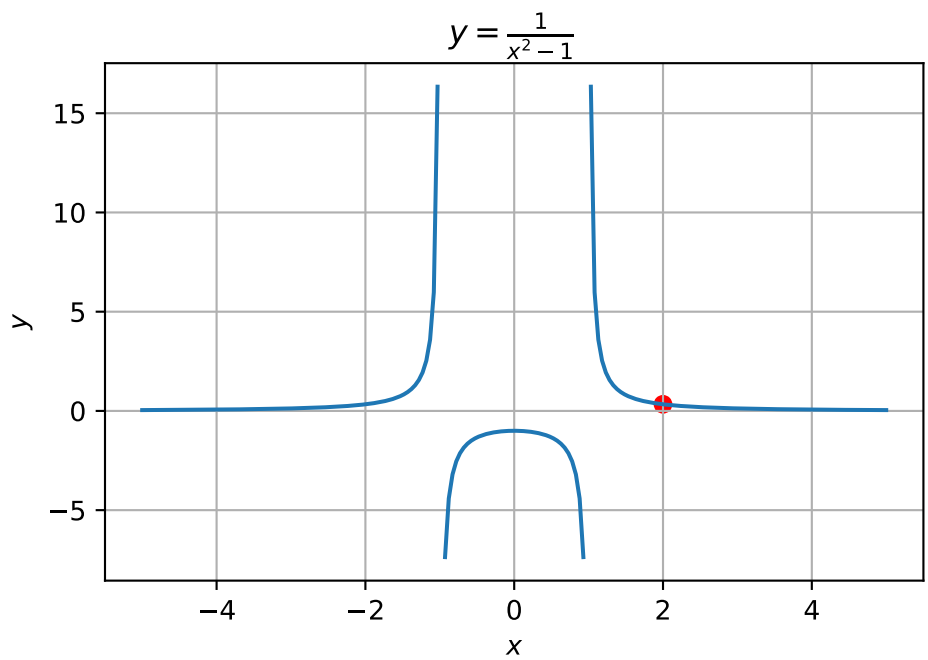


Figure 1.1: Exercises 1.2: 3

1.2: 7. $x(t) = c_1 \cos t + c_2 \sin t$ is a two-parameter family of solutions of the second-order DE $x'' + x = 0$. Find a solution of the second-order IVP consisting of this differential equation and the given initial conditions

$$x(0) = -1,\ x'(0) = 8$$

Solution

$$
\begin{aligned}
x(t) &= c_1 \cos t + c_2 \sin t \\
&\Downarrow \ {\scriptstyle x(0)=-1,\ x'(0)=8} \\
-1 &= c_1 \\
8 &= c_2 \\
&\Downarrow \\
x(t) &= -\cos t + 8 \sin t
\end{aligned}
$$

1.2: 17. Determine a region of the xy-plane for which the given differential equation would have a unique solution whose graph passes through a point (x_0, y_0) in the region.

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = y^{2/3}$$

Solution

1.2: 29.

1. By inspection, find a one-parameter family of solutions of the differential equation $xy' = y$. Verify that each member of the family is a solution of the initial value problem $xy' = y, y(0) = 0$
2. Explain part 1. by determining a region R in the xy-plane for which the differential equation $xy' = y$ would have a unique solution through a point (x_0, y_0) in R
3. Verify that the piecewise-defined function

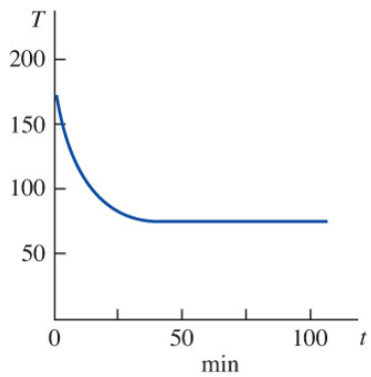
$$y = \begin{cases} 0, & x < 0 \\ x, & x \geq 0 \end{cases}$$

satisfies the condition $y(0) = 0$. Determine whether this function is also a solution of the initial-value problem in part 1

Solution

1.3: 5. A cup of coffee cools according to Newton's law of cooling. Use data from the graph of the temperature $T(t)$ in figure to estimate the constants T_m, T_0, and k in a model of the form of the first-order initial-value problem

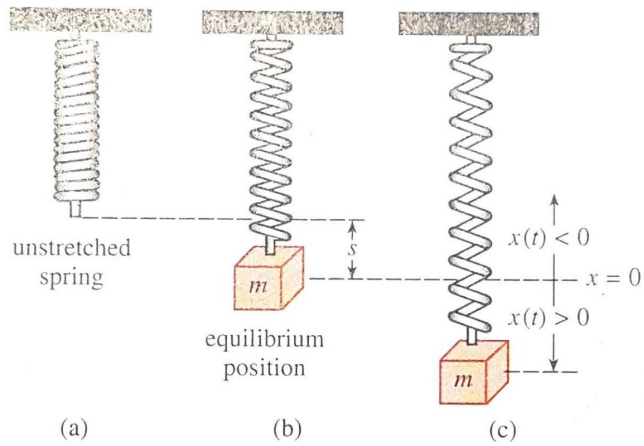
$$\frac{dT}{dt} = k(T - T_m), \ \ T(0) = T_0$$



Solution

$$\frac{dT}{dt} = k(T - T_m), \quad T(0) = T_0$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$T(0) = T_0$$
$$T(\infty) = T_m$$
$$\ln\left(\frac{T - T_m}{T_0 - T_m}\right) = kt$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$k \text{ is the slope of the graph of } t \text{ vs. } \ln\left(\frac{T - T_m}{T_0 - T_m}\right)$$

1.3: 19. After a mass m is attached to a spring, it stretches s units and then hangs at rest in the equilibrium position as shown in Figure (b). After the spring/mass system has been set in motion, let $x(t)$ denote the directed distance of the mass beyond the equilibrium position. As indicated in Figure (c), assume that the downward direction is positive, that the motion takes place in a vertical straight line through the center of gravitiy of the mass, and that the only forces acting on the system are the weight of the mass and the restoring force of the stretched spring. Use Hooke's law: The restoring force of a spring is proportional to its total elongation. Determine a differential equation for the displacement $x(t)$ a time t


unstretched
spring
s
m
equilibrium
position
x(t) < 0
x = 0
x(t) > 0
m
(a)
(b)
(c)

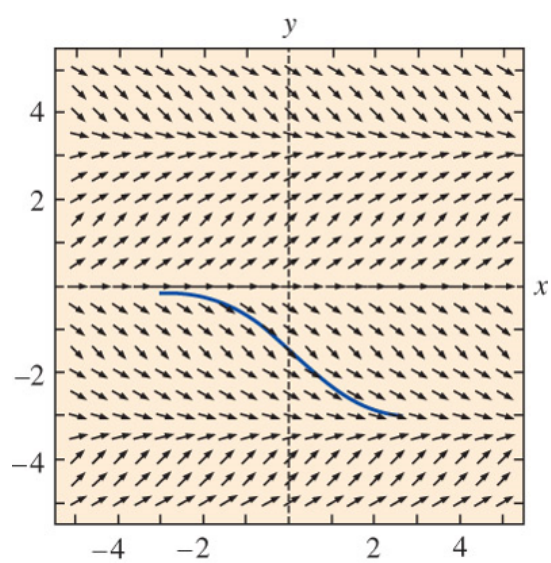
Solution

2 First-Order Differential Equations

2.1 Solution Curves Without a Solution

- DEs can be analyzed qualitatively, allowing us to approximate a solution curve without solving the problem
- Two approaches are:
  - Direction fields
  - Autonomous first-order DEs
- Direction fields:
  - Slope of the **lineal element** at $(x, y(x))$ on a solution curve is the value of $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at this point
  - **Direction/slope fields** of $\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x, y)$ are collections of lineal slope elements that visually suggest the shape of a family of solution curves

For example, $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \sin y$

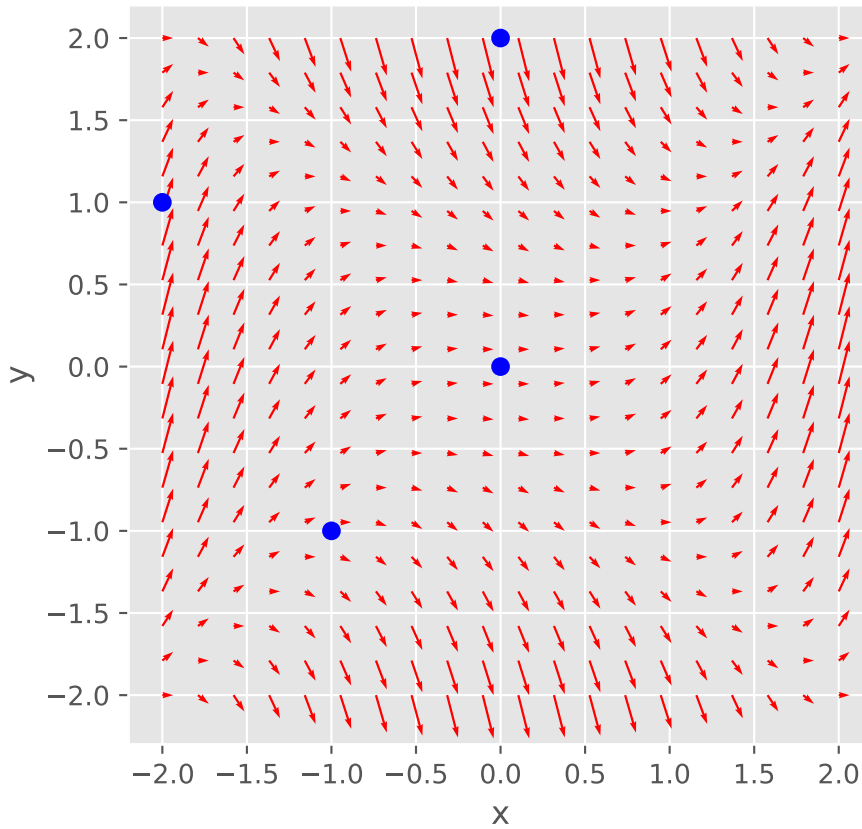


- Using the given computer-generated direction field, sketch, by hand, an approximate solution curve that passes through each of the indicated points:

$$\frac{df}{dx} = x^2 - y^2$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&(a)\ \ y(-2) = 1\\
&(b)\ \ y(-1) = -1\\
&(c)\ \ y(0) = 2\\
&(d)\ \ y(0) = 0
\end{aligned}$$

```
import numpy as np
from scipy import integrate

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
plt.style.use('ggplot')

x = np.linspace(-2, 2, 20)
y = np.linspace(-2, 2, 20)
X, Y = np.meshgrid(x, y)

dy = (X*X -Y*Y)
dx = np.ones(dy.shape)

plt.figure(figsize=(5, 5))
plt.quiver(X, Y, dx, dy, color='red')
plt.plot([-2, -1, 0, 0], [1, -1, 2, 0], 'o', color="blue")
plt.xlim([-2.2, 2.2])
plt.ylim([-2.3, 2.2])
plt.xticks(np.arange(-2, 2.5, 0.5))
plt.yticks(np.arange(-2, 2.5, 0.5))
plt.xlabel('x')
plt.ylabel('y')

plt.show()
```



- **Autonomous** first-order DEs, $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = f(y)$

  An ODE in which the independent variable does not appear explicitly

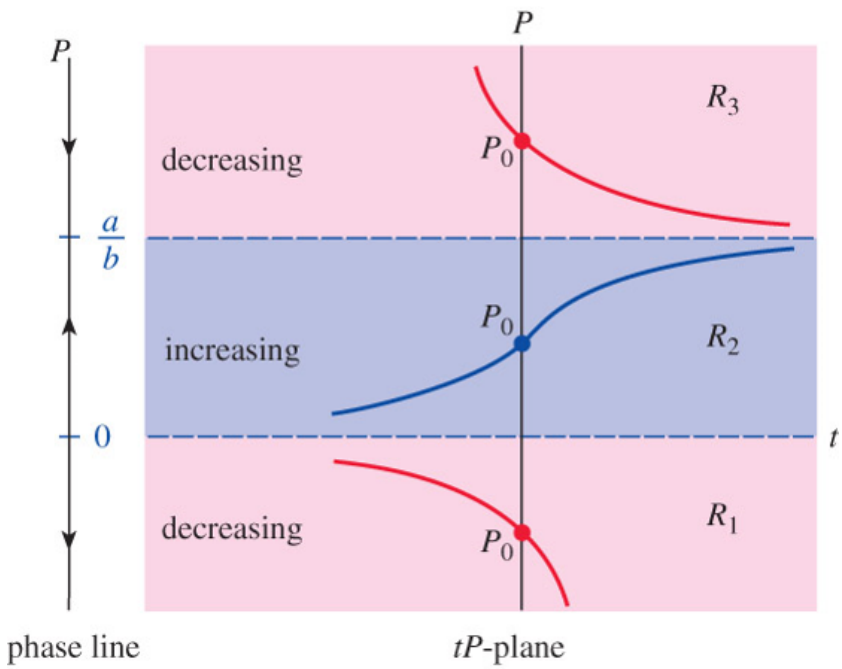
$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 1 + y^2 \quad \text{autonomous}$$
$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 0.2\,xy \quad \text{nonautonomous}$$

- **Critical points**, $f(c) = 0$, are constant (or equilibrium) solutions of autonomous DEs
- A **phase portrait** is made by putting critical points on a vertical line with phase lines pointing up or down, depending on the sign of the function over intervals between the points
- Some conclusions can be drawn about nonconstant solution curves to autonomous DEs
  - If a solution $y(x)$ passes through (x_0, y_0) in sub-region R_i, then $y(x)$ remains in R_i
  - By continuity, $f(y)$ cannot change signs in a sub-region R_i

– Since $f(y)$ is either positive or negative in R_i, a solution is either increasing or decreasing and has no relative extremum

Example Phase portrait and solution curves

$$\frac{dP}{dt} = P(a - bP)$$



Example Consider the autonomous first-order differential equation

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = y^2 - y^4$$

and the initial condition $y(0) = y_0$. Sketch the graph of a typical solution $y(x)$ when y_0 has the given values

$$\begin{array}{ll} (a) & y_0 < -1 \\ (b) & -1 < y_0 < 0 \\ (c) & 0 < y_0 < 1 \\ (d) & 1 < y_0 \end{array}$$

2.2 Separable Equations

- Consider $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = f(x)$
  - When f does not depend on y, $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = f(x)$, which can be solved by integration
  - The solution $y = \displaystyle\int f(x)dx = F(x) + c$, where $F(x)$ is an antiderivative (indefinite integral)
  - Some functions, termed **nonelementary**, do not possess an antiderivative that is an elementary function

- A first-order DE of the form $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = g(x)h(y)$ is said to be **separable**, or have **separable variables**
  - A separable equation can be rewritten in the form

$$\frac{1}{h(y)}dy = g(x)dx$$

    which is solved by integrating both sides

Example Solve a separable equation $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = y^2 - 9$, $y(0) = 0$

- Separating and using partial fractions

$$\frac{dy}{(y-3)(y+3)} = dx$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$\frac{1}{6}\left[\frac{1}{y-3} - \frac{1}{y+3}\right]dy = dx$$

- Integrating and solving for y yields

$$\frac{1}{6}\ln\left|\frac{y-3}{y+3}\right| = x + c_1$$
$$\Downarrow c = e^{6c_1}$$
$$y = 3\frac{1 - ce^{6x}}{1 + ce^{6x}}$$

- Finally, applying $y(0) = 0$ gives $c = 1$

Example Solve the given differential equation by separation of variables

- $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \sin 5x$
- $dx + e^{3x}dy = 0$
- $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = x\sqrt{1-y^2}$

Example Find an implicit and an explicit solution of the given initial-value problem

- $x^2\dfrac{dy}{dx} = y - xy, \quad y(-1) = -1$
- $\dfrac{dx}{dt} = 4(x^2+1), \quad x(\pi/4) = 1$

2.3 Linear Equations

A first-order DE of the form $a_1(x)\dfrac{dy}{dx} + a_0(x)y = g(x)$ is a **linear equation** in the dependent variable y

- The DE is **homogeneous** when $g(x) = 0$; otherwise, it is **nonhomogeneous**
- The standard form of a linear DE is obtained by dividing both sides by the lead coefficient

$$\frac{dy}{dx} + P(x)y = f(x)$$

The **standard form** equation has the property that its solution y is the sum of the solution of the associated homogeneous equation y_h and the particular solution of the nonhomogeneous equation y_p :

$$y = y_h + y_p$$

- The homogeneous equation $\dfrac{dy_h}{dx} + P(x)y_h = 0$ is separable, allowing us to solve for y_h

$$\frac{dy_h}{y_h} = -P(x)dx$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$\ln|y_h| = -\int P(x)\,dx + \bar{c} \Rightarrow y_h = c\exp\left(-\int P(x)\,dx\right)$$

- **Variation of parameters** $y_p = u(x)y_h$ can be used to solve the nonhomogeneous equation of y_p

$$y_h\frac{du}{dx} + \underbrace{\left(\frac{dy_h}{dx} + P(x)y_h\right)}_{=0} u = f(x)$$
$$du = \frac{f(x)}{y_h}dx \Rightarrow u(x) = \int \frac{f(x)}{y_h(x)}dx$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$y_p = y_p\int \frac{f(x)}{y_h(x)}dx$$

Example Find the general solution of the given differential equation:

- $\dfrac{dy}{dx} + 2y = 0$
- $y' + 2xy = x^3$
- $x\dfrac{dy}{dx} + 2y = 3$
- $xy' + (1+x)y = e^{-x}\sin 2x$

Example Solve the given initial-value problem. Give the largest interval I over which the solution is defined

- $y\dfrac{dx}{dy} - x = 2y^2, \;\; y(1) = 5$
- $(x+1)\dfrac{dy}{dx} + y = \ln x, \;\; y(1) = 10$

Example The given differential equation is not linear in y. Nevertheless, find a general solution of the equation

- $dx = (x + y^2)dy$
- $ydx + (2x + xy - 3)dy = 0$

Example The sine integral function is defined as

$$\mathrm{Si}(x) = \int_0^x \frac{\sin t}{t}\, dt$$

where the integrand is defined to be 1 at $x = 0$. Express the solution of the initial value problem

$$x^3 \frac{dy}{dx} + 2x^2 y = 10 \sin x, \quad y(1) = 0$$

in terms of $\mathrm{Si}(x)$

2.4 Exact Equations

- A differential expression $M(x,y)dx + N(x,y)dy$ is an **exact differential** in a region R of the xy-plane if it corresponds to the differential of some function $f(x,y)$:

$$df(x,y) = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} dx + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} dy$$

- and a condition of exact differentials is:

$$\frac{\partial M}{\partial y} = \frac{\partial N}{\partial x}$$

- $M(x,y)\, dx + N(x,y)\, dy = 0$ is an **exact equation** if the left side is an exact differential

Example Solving an exact DE, $2xy\, dx + (x^2 - 1)\, dy = 0$

- **Integrating Factor** of the first-order linear DE

$$\frac{dy}{dx} + P(x)y = f(x)$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$(P(x)y - f(x))\,dx + dy = 0$$
$$\Downarrow \times I(x): \text{ Integrating Factor}$$
$$I(x)\,(P(x)y - f(x))\,dx + I(x)dy = 0$$

To be an exact equation $\Downarrow$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial y}\left\{I(x)\,(P(x)y - f(x))\right\} = I(x)P(x) = \frac{d}{dx}I(x)$$
$$\Downarrow\ I(x) = \exp\left(\int P(x)dx\right)$$

Then

$$I(x)\frac{dy}{dx} + I(x)P(x)y = I(x)f(x) \ \Rightarrow\ \frac{d}{dx}\left\{I(x)y\right\} = I(x)f(x)$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$y(x) = I(x)^{-1}y(x_0)I(x_0) + I(x)^{-1}\int_{x_0}^{x} I(x)f(x)dx$$

Example Solve $\dfrac{dy}{dx} - 2xy = 2,\ y(0) = 1$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} - 2xy = 2$$
$$\Downarrow \times e^{-x^2}$$
$$\frac{d}{dx}[e^{-x^2}y] = 2e^{-x^2}$$
$$y = ce^{x^2} + 2e^{x^2}\int_0^x e^{-t^2}dt$$
$$\Downarrow y(0) = 1 \to c = 1$$
$$y = e^{x^2}\left[1 + \sqrt{\pi}\,\underbrace{\left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}}\int_0^x e^{-t^2}dt\right)}_{\mathrm{erf}(x)}\right]$$
$$= e^{x^2}\left[1 + \sqrt{\pi}\,\mathrm{erf}(x)\right]$$

Example Determine whether the given differential equation is exact. If it is exact, solve it

- $(2x-1)dx + (3y+7)dy = 0$
- $(5x+4y)dx + (4x-8y^2)dy = 0$
- $(2xy^2-3)dx + (2x^2y+4)dy = 0$
- $(x^2-y^2)dx + (x^2-2xy)dy = 0$

Example Solve the given initial-value problem

- $(x+y)^2dx + (2xy+x^2-1)dy = 0, \;\; y(1) = 1$
- $(4y+2t-5)dt + (6y+4t-1)dy = 0, \;\; y(-1) = 2$

Example Solve the given differential equation by finding an appropriate integrating factor

- $y(x+y+1)dx + (x+2y)dy = 0$

2.5 Solutions by Substitutions

Substitution is often used to get a DE in a form that a known procedure can be used to find a solution

- Reduction to separation of variables can be facilitated in the DE

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = f(Ax+By+C)$$

by substituting $u = Ax+By+C, \; B \neq 0$

Example Solve the IVP $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = (-2x+y)^2 - 7, \; y(0) = 0$

Let $u = -2x+y$,

then $\dfrac{du}{dx} = -2 + \dfrac{dy}{dx}$ giving $\dfrac{du}{dx} = u^2 - 9$

- **Homogeneous** first-order DE

  A first-order ordinary DE in the form:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x,y) = -\frac{M(x,y)}{N(x,y)}$$

  is a homogeneous type if both function $M(x,y)$ and $N(x,y)$ are homogeneous functions of the same degree n:

$$M(\lambda x, \lambda y) = \lambda^n M(x,y), \quad N(\lambda x, \lambda y) = \lambda^n N(x,y)$$

  Thus, we can let $t = 1/x$ to simplify this quotient to a function f of the single variable y/x:

$$\frac{M(x,y)}{N(x,y)} = \frac{M(tx,ty)}{N(tx,ty)} = \frac{M\left(1, \frac{y}{x}\right)}{N\left(1, \frac{y}{x}\right)} = -f\left(\frac{y}{x}\right) = -\frac{dy}{dx}$$

  The change of variables $y = ux$ transforms the original differential equation into the separable form:

$$\frac{du}{f(u) - u} = \frac{dx}{x}$$

- **Bernoulli** DE:

$$y' + P(x)y = Q(x)y^n \quad \text{where} \quad n \neq 0 \quad \text{and } n \neq 1$$

  - Bernoulli equations are special because they are nonlinear differential equations with known exact solutions
  - The substitution $u = y^{1-n}$ reduces any Bernoulli equation to a linear differential equation

Example Solve $y' - \dfrac{2}{x}y = -x^2y^2$

Changing variables $u = \frac{1}{y}$, $u' = -\frac{1}{y^2}y'$ gives the equation

$$u' + \frac{2}{x}u = x^2$$

- **Riccati** DE
  - Riccati equation is any first-order ordinary differential equation that is quadratic in the unknown function. In other words, it is an equation of the form

    $$y' = q_0(x) + q_1(x)y + q_2(x)y^2$$

    where $q_0(x) \neq 0$ and $q_2(x) \neq 0$. If $q_0(x) = 0$, the equation is Bernoulli one, and if $q_2(x) = 0$, the equation is linear one
  - The new variable $v = yq_2$ satisfies an equation

    $$v' = v^2 + R(x)v + S(x)$$

    where $S(x) = q_2 q_0$ and $R(x) = q_1 + \left(\frac{q_2'}{q_2}\right)$
  - Substituting $v = -\frac{u'}{u}$, u satisfies the linear 2nd order ODE

    $$u'' - R(x)u' + S(x)u = 0$$

    A solution of this equation will lead to a solution $y = -\frac{u'}{q_2 u}$ of the original Riccati equation

Example Solve the given differential equation by using an appropriate substitution

- $(x - y)dx + xdy = 0$
- $xdx + (y - 2x)dy = 0$
- $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \dfrac{y - x}{y + x}$
- $x\dfrac{dy}{dx} = y + \sqrt{x^2 - y^2}, \quad x > 0$

Example Solve the given initial-value problem

- $xy^2\dfrac{dy}{dx} = y^3 - x^3, \quad y(1) = 2$
- $(x^2 + 2y^2)\dfrac{dx}{dy} = xy, \quad y(-1) = 1$

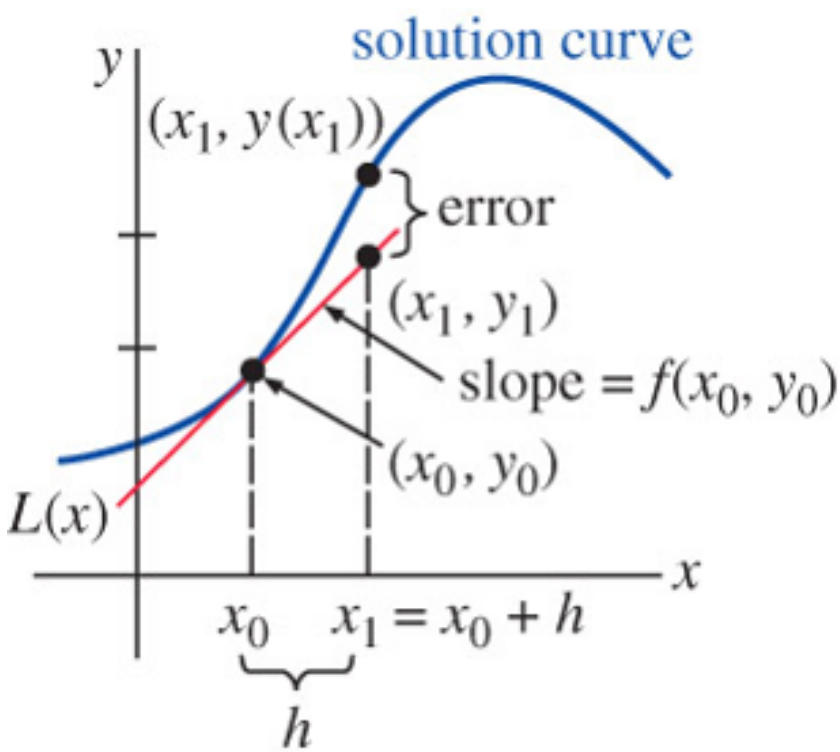
Example Solve the given differential equation by using an appropriate substitution

- $x\dfrac{dy}{dx} + y = \dfrac{1}{y^2}$
- $3(1+t^2)\dfrac{dy}{dt} = 2ty(y^3 - 1)$
- $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \cos(x+y), \;\; y(0) = \dfrac{\pi}{4}$

2.6 A Numerical Method

Numerical method: an algorithm for approximating the unknown solution to a DE

- **Linearization** approximates solutions within a small area around lineal elements in direction fields
- The procedure of evaluating successive tangent lines is **Euler's method**



Example Consider $y' = 0.1\sqrt{y} + 0.4x^2,\; y(2) = 4$ and approximate $y(2.5)$ using $h = 0.1$

- Substituting into the general formula for Euler's method gives

$$y_{n+1} = y_n + h\left(0.1\sqrt{y_n} + 0.4x_n^2\right)$$

- Considering the initial condition and $n = 0$

$$\begin{aligned}
y_1 &= 4 + 0.1\left(0.1\sqrt{4} + 0.4 \cdot 2^2\right) = 4.1800 \\
y_2 &= 4.18 + 0.1\left(0.1\sqrt{4.18} + 0.4 \cdot 2.1^2\right) = 4.3768 \\
&\vdots \\
y_5 &= 5.0768
\end{aligned}$$

```python
plt.style.use('ggplot')

x0 = 2.0
y0 = 4.0
xf = 2.5

h = 0.1
n = int((xf - x0)/h) + 1

x = np.linspace(x0, xf, n)
y = np.zeros(n)

y[0] = y0
for i in range(1, n):
    y[i] = y[i -1] + h*(0.1 * np.sqrt(y[i -1]) + 0.4 * x[i -1]**2)
    print(f'x = {x[i] : 3.1f}, y = {y[i] : 5.4f}')

plt.figure(figsize=(4, 4))
plt.plot(x, y, 'o')
plt.xlabel("$x$")
plt.ylabel("$y$")
plt.title("$h=0.1$")

plt.show()
```

```
x =  2.1, y =  4.1800
x =  2.2, y =  4.3768
x =  2.3, y =  4.5914
x =  2.4, y =  4.8244
x =  2.5, y =  5.0768
```

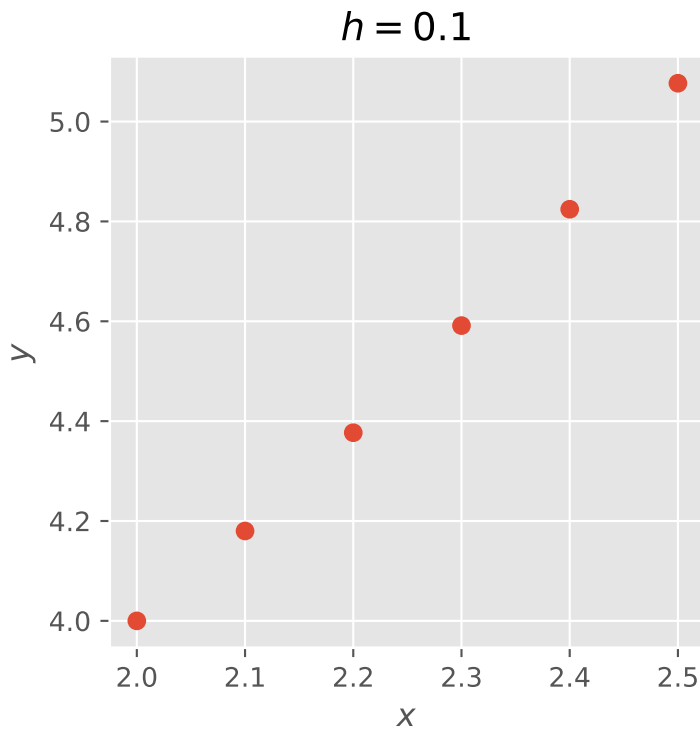


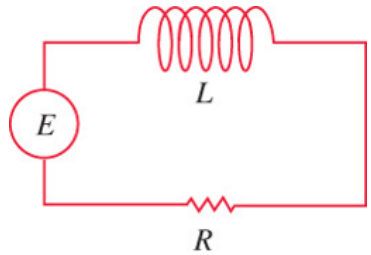
Figure 2.1: Euler's Method

Example Use Euler's method to obtain a four-decimal approximation of the indicated value. Carry out the recursion, first using $h = 0.1$ and then using $h = 0.05$

$$y' = 2x - 3y + 1, \;\; y(1) = 5; \;\; y(1.2)$$

2.7 Linear Models

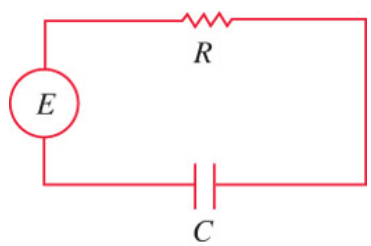
Example Series Circuits - For a series circuit containing a resister R and an inductor L,



Kirchoff's second law gives

$$L\frac{di}{dt} + Ri = E(t)$$

For a series circuit containing a resister and a capacitor,



Kirchoff's second law gives

$$Ri + \frac{1}{C}q = E(t)$$

where $i = \dfrac{dq}{dt}$. Then $R\dfrac{dq}{dt} + \dfrac{1}{C}q = E(t)$

Example The population of a community is known to increase at a rate proportional to the number of people present at time t. If an initial population P_0 has doubled in 5 years, how long will it take to triple? To quadruple?

2.8 Nonlinear Models

Example The logistic model

- Verhulst proposed a model, called the logistic model, for population growth in 1838. It does not assume unlimited resources. Instead, it assumes there is a carrying capacity K for the population
- This carrying capacity is the stable population level. If the population is above K, then the population will decrease, but if below, then it will increase
- For this model, it is assumed that ther rate of change $\frac{dy}{dt}$ of the population y is proportional to the product of the current population y and $K - y$

$$\frac{dy}{dt} = \alpha y(K - y)$$

2.9 Modeling with Systems of First-Order DEs

Example Radioactive Series:

$$X \xrightarrow{k_1} Y \xrightarrow{k_2} Z$$

- The decay of the initial element X is described by

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = -k_1 x$$

- The second element Y is produced by the decay of X and loses from its own spontaneous decay

$$\frac{dy}{dt} = k_1 x - k_2 y$$

- The stable element z is generated from the decay of Y

$$\frac{dz}{dt} = k_2 y$$

Example Consider the Lotka-Volterra predator-prey model defined by

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = -0.1x + 0.02xy$$
$$\frac{dy}{dt} = 0.2y - 0.025xy$$

where the populations $x(t)$ (predator) and $y(t)$ (prey) are measured in the thousands and $x(0) = 6$ and $y(0) = 6$

- Use a numerical solver to graph $x(t)$ and $y(t)$

```
# Lotka-Volterra predator-prey model
a, b, c, d = -0.1, 0.02, 0.2, -0.025

def f(t, xy):
    x, y = xy
    return [a *x +b *x *y, c *y +d *x *y]

# Initial condition and Time span
xy0 = [6, 6]
tf = 400
t_eval = np.linspace(0, tf, 5*tf)

# Numerical Solver
sol = integrate.solve_ivp(f, [0, tf], xy0, t_eval=t_eval)

t = sol.t
xy_t = sol.y.T
```

- Use the graphs to approximate the period of each population

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots(1, 1, figsize=(6, 5))

ax.plot(t, xy_t[:, 0], 'r', label="Predator")
ax.plot(t, xy_t[:, 1], 'b', label="Prey")

ax.set_xlabel("Time")
ax.set_ylabel("Number of animals")
ax.set_xlim(0, tf)
ax.set_ylim(0, 12)
ax.legend()

plt.show()
```

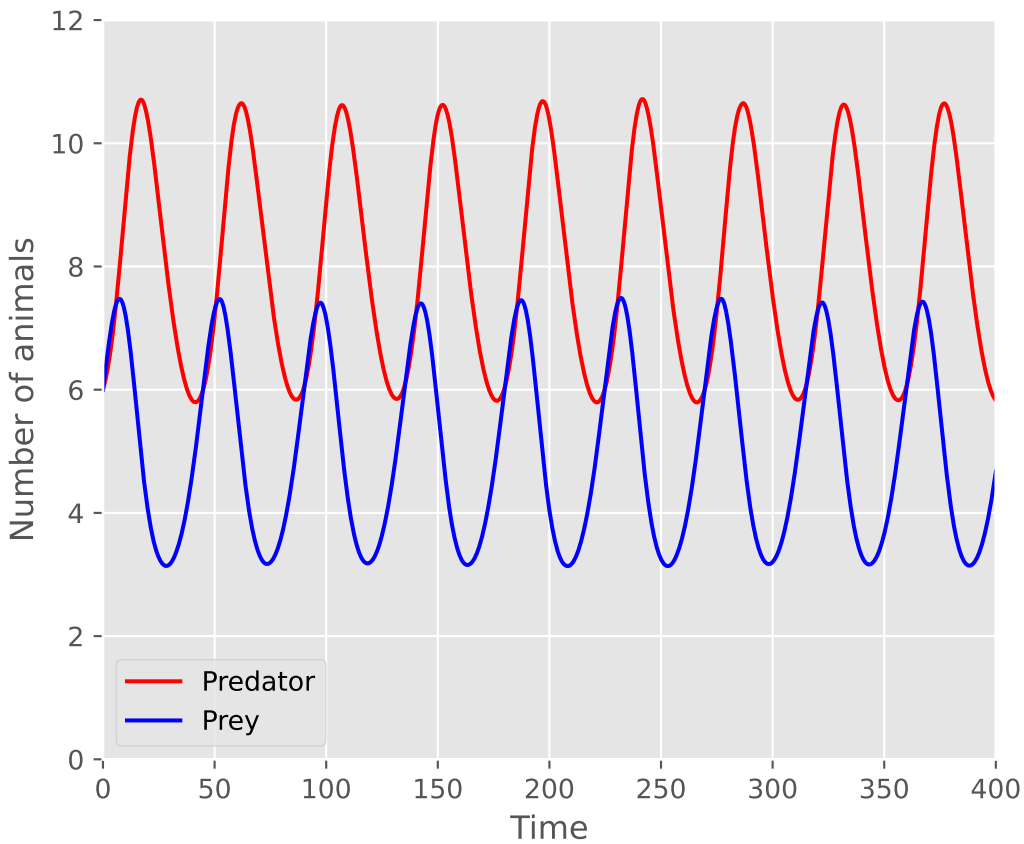


Figure 2.2: Lotka-Volterra predator-prey model

Worked Exercises

Solve the given differential equation by separation of variables

2.2: 1. $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \sin 5x$

Solution

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dy}{dx} &= \sin 5x \\ &\Downarrow \\ dy &= \sin 5x\, dx \\ &\Downarrow \\ y &= -\frac{1}{5}\cos 5x + c \end{aligned}$$

2.2: 3. $dx + e^{3x}dy = 0$

Solution

$$\begin{aligned} dy &= -e^{-3x}\, dx \\ &\Downarrow \\ y &= \frac{1}{3}e^{-3x} + c \end{aligned}$$

2.2: 21. $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = x\sqrt{1-y^2}$

Solution

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-y^2}}dy &= x\, dx \\ &\Downarrow \\ \arcsin y &= \frac{1}{2}x^2 + c \\ &\Downarrow \\ y &= \sin\left(\frac{1}{2}x^2 + c\right) \end{aligned}$$

2.2: 25. Find an implicit or an explicit solution of the given initial-value problem

$$x^2\frac{dy}{dx} = y - xy, \quad y(-1) = -1$$

Solution

$$\frac{1}{y}dy = \frac{1-x}{x^2}\,dx$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$\ln|y| = -\left(\frac{1}{x} + \ln|x|\right) + c$$
$$\Downarrow y(-1) = -1 \;\Rightarrow\; c = -1$$
$$\ln|y| = -\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right) - \ln|x|$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$y = \frac{1}{x}e^{-(1+\frac{1}{x})}$$

2.7: 41. Evaporating Raindrop As a raindrop falls, it evaporates while retaining its spherical shape. If we make the further assumptions that the rate at which the raindrop evaporates is proportional to its surface area and that air resistance is negligible, then a model for the velocity $v(t)$ of the raindrop is

$$\frac{dv}{dt} + \frac{3(k/\rho)}{(k/\rho)t + r_0}v = g$$

Here ρ is the density of water, r_0 is the radius of the raindrop at $t = 0$, $k < 0$ is the constant of proportionality $\frac{dm}{dt} = 4\pi r^2 k$, and the downward direction is taken to be the positive direction

(a) Solve for $v(t)$ if the raindrop falls from the rest

(b) Show that the radius of the raindrop at time t is $r(t) = (k/\rho)t + r_0$

(c) If $r_0 = 0.01$ ft and $r = 0.007$ ft at time $t = 10$ sec after the raindrop falls from a cloud, determine the time at which the raindrop has evaporated completely

Solution

(a)

$$\frac{dv}{dt} + \frac{3(k/\rho)}{(k/\rho)t + r_0} v = g$$

$$\Downarrow \text{ multiply by the integral factor}$$

$$\frac{d}{dt}\left[\left(\frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0\right)^3 v\right] = \left(\frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0\right)^3 g$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$v(t) = \frac{g\rho}{4k}\left(\frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0\right) + c\left(\frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0\right)^{-3}$$

$$\Downarrow \; v(0) = 0 \;\rightarrow\; c = -\frac{g\rho}{4k} r_0^4$$

$$v(t) = \frac{g\rho}{4k}\left(\frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0\right)\left[1 - \left(\frac{r_0}{\frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0}\right)^4\right]$$

(b)

$$m = \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3 \rho$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$\frac{dm}{dt} = 4\pi r^2 \rho \frac{dr}{dt}$$

$$\Downarrow \; \tfrac{dm}{dt} = 4\pi r^2 k$$

$$\frac{dr}{dt} = \frac{k}{\rho}$$

$$\Downarrow \; r = r_0 \text{ at } t = 0$$

$$r(t) = \frac{k}{\rho}t + r_0$$

(c)

$$r(10) = \frac{k}{\rho} \times 10 + 0.01 = 0.007 \;\Rightarrow\; \frac{k}{\rho} = -0.0003$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$r(t) = -0.0003t + 0.01 = 0 \;\Rightarrow\; t = \frac{0.01}{0.0003} \approx 33.3 \text{ sec}$$

3 Higher-Order Differential Equations

3.1 Theory of Linear Equations

- In an **initial-value problem (IVP)**, we seek a solution $y(x)$ of a nth order linear DE so that $y(x)$ satisfies **initial conditions** at x_0
  - n^{th} order linear DE: $a_n(x) \neq 0$

$$\underbrace{a_n(x)\frac{d^n y}{dx^n} + a_{n-1}(x)\frac{d^{n-1}y}{dx^{n-1}} + \cdots + a_1(x)\frac{dy}{dx} + a_0(x)y}_{L(y)\text{: Linear Operator}} = g(x)$$

  - Initial conditions

$$y(x_0) = y_0,\ y'(x_0) = y_1, \cdots,\ y^{(n-1)}(x_0) = y_{n-1}$$

- **Boundary-value problem (BVP)** consists of solving a linear DE of order 2 or greater, in which the dependent variable y or its derivatives are specified at **different points**
  - For example,

$$a_2(x)\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} + a_1(x)\frac{dy}{dx} + a_0(x)y = g(x)$$

  - Boundary conditions

$$y(x_0) = y_0,\ y(x_1) = y_1$$

- The sum, or **superposition** , of two or more solutions of a homogeneous linear DE is also a solution
- Any set of n linearly *independent* solutions $y_1, y_2, \cdots, y_n$ of the nth order homogeneous linear DE on interval I is **a fundamental set of solutions**
- If two functions are linearly dependent, then one is a constant multiple of the other (otherwise, they are linearly independent)

- If $\{y_1, y_2, \cdots, y_n\}$ are a set of linearly independent functions, the **Wronskian** function is not singular:

$$W(y_1, y_2, \cdots, y_n) = \begin{vmatrix} y_1 & y_2 & \cdots & y_n \\ y_1' & y_2' & \cdots & y_n' \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ y_1^{(n-1)} & y_2^{(n-1)} & \cdots & y_n^{(n-1)} \end{vmatrix} \neq 0$$

- General solution of nth order *homogeneous* linear DE is

$$y(x) = c_1 y_1(x) + c_2 y_2(x) + \cdots + c_n y_n(x)$$

  where $y_1, y_2, \cdots, y_n$ is a fundamental set of solutions and $c_i,\ i = 1, 2, \cdots, n$ are arbitrary constants

- General solution of nth order *nonhomogeneous* linear DE is

$$y(x) = c_1 y_1(x) + c_2 y_2(x) + \cdots + c_n y_n(x) + y_p(x)$$

  where $y_1, y_2, \cdots, y_n$ is a fundamental set of solutions, y_p is a particular solution, and $c_i,\ i = 1, 2, \cdots, n$ are arbitrary constants

Example Given that $x(t) = c_1 \cos \omega t + c_2 \sin \omega t$ is the general solution of $x'' + \omega^2 x = 0$ on the interval $(-\infty, \infty)$, show that a solution satisfying the initial conditions $x(0) = x_0$, $x'(0) = x_1$, is given by

$$x(t) = x_0 \cos \omega t + \frac{x_1}{\omega} \sin \omega t$$

Example Determine whether the given set of functions is linearly dependent or linearly independent on the interval $(-\infty, \infty)$

$$f_1(x) = x,\ f_2(x) = x^2,\ f_3(x) = 4x - 3x^2$$

$$f_1(x) = 5,\ f_2(x) = \cos^2 x,\ f_3(x) = \sin^2 x$$

Example Verify that the given functions form a fundamental set of solutions of the differential equation on the indicated interval. Form the general solution of the equation

$$y'' - y' - 12y = 0; \quad e^{-3x}, \; e^{4x}, \quad (-\infty, \infty)$$

$$y'' - 2y' + 5y = 0; \quad e^{x}\cos 2x, \quad e^{x}\sin 2x, \quad (-\infty, \infty)$$

Example Verify that the given two-parameter family of functions is the general solution of the nonhomogeneous differential equation on the indicated interval

$$y'' - 7y' + 10y = 24e^{x}; \quad y = c_1 e^{2x} + c_2 e^{5x} + 6e^{x}; \quad (-\infty, \infty)$$

$$y'' - 4y' + 4y = 2e^{2x} + 4x - 12; \quad y = c_1 e^{2x} + c_2 x e^{2x} + x^2 e^{2x} + x - 2; \quad (-\infty, \infty)$$

3.2 Reduction of Order

- **Reduction of order** can be used to reduce a linear *second-order* DE with known solution y_1 into a linear *first-order* DE, which can be solved for a second solution y_2
- Applying reduction of order $y_2 = u(x)y_1$ to the standard form of a second-order linear homogeneous DE

$$y'' + P(x)y' + Q(x)y = 0$$

gives

$$\begin{aligned} y_1 u'' + (2y_1' + P(x)y_1)\, u' &= 0 \\ \Downarrow \; \times y_1, \; u' &= w \\ (y_1^2 w)' &= -(y_1^2 w)P(x) \\ \Downarrow & \\ y_2(x) &= y_1(x) \int \frac{\exp\left(-\int P(x)\,dx\right)}{y_1^2(x)}\,dx \end{aligned}$$

Example The indicated function $y_1(x)$ is a solution of the given equation. Use the reduction of order to find a second solution $y_2(x)$

- $y'' - 4y' + 4y = 0; \quad y_1 = e^{2x}$
- $y'' + 16y = 0; \quad y_1 = \cos 4x$
- $y'' - y = 0; \quad y_1 = \cosh x$

Example The indicated function $y_1(x)$ is a solution of the associated homogeneous equation. Use the reduction of order to find a second solution $y_2(x)$ of homogeneous equation and a particular solution $y_p(x)$ of the given nonhomogeneous equation

$$y'' - 4y = 2; \quad y_1 = e^{-2x}$$

3.3 Homogeneous Linear Equations with Constant Coefficients

The general solution of $ay'' + by' + cy = 0$ is found by substituting $y = e^{px}$ and solving the resulting **characteristic equation** $ap^2 + bp + c = 0$ for roots p_1 and p_2

- **Case I** p_1 and p_2 are real and distinct

$$y = c_1 e^{p_1 x} + c_2 e^{p_2 x}$$

- **Case II** p_1 and p_2 are real and equal

$$y = c_1 e^{p_1} x + c_2 x e^{p_1 x}$$

- **Case III** p_1 and p_2 are complex conjugate: $p_1, p_2 = \alpha \pm i\beta$

$$y = e^{\alpha} x \left(c_1 \cos \beta x + c_2 \sin \beta x\right)$$

Example Solve $y'' + \omega^2 y = 0$ and $y'' - \omega^2 y = 0$

Example Solve $3y''' + 5y'' + 10y' - 4y = 0$

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.integrate import solve_ivp

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
```

```python
from sympy import Symbol, init_printing
from sympy.solvers import solve
init_printing()

x = Symbol('x')
solve(3*x**3 +5*x**2 +10*x -4, x)
```

$$\left[\frac{1}{3},\ -1-\sqrt{3}i,\ -1+\sqrt{3}i\right]$$

Example Find the general solution of the given second-order differential equation

- $4y'' + y' = 0$
- $y'' - y' - 6y = 0$
- $y'' + 8y' + 16y = 0$

Example Find the general solution of the given higher-order differential equation

- $y''' - 4y'' - 5y' = 0$
- $y''' - 5y'' + 3y' + 9y = 0$

Example Solve the initial-value problem

$y''' + 12y'' + 36y' = 0,\ \ y(0) = 0,\ y'(0) = 1,\ y''(0) = -7$

3.4 Undetermined Coefficients

Method of undetermined coefficients can be used to obtain a particular solution y_p

- The underlying idea is a conjecture about the form of y_p based on the kinds of functions making up the input function $g(x)$
- Limited to nonhomogeneous linear DEs where
  - Coefficients a_i, $i = 1, \cdots, n$, are constants

- $g(x)$ is a constant, a polynominal function, $e^{\alpha x}$, $\sin \beta x$ or $\cos \beta x$, or finite sums and products of these functions

- There are models of y_p for various functions

$g(x)$	Form of y_p
1. 1 (any constant)	A
2. $5x + 7$	$Ax + B$
3. $3x^2 - 2$	$Ax^2 + Bx + C$
4. $x^3 - x + 1$	$Ax^3 + Bx^2 + Cx + E$
5. $\sin 4x$	$A \cos 4x + B \sin 4x$
6. $\cos 4x$	$A \cos 4x + B \sin 4x$
7. e^{5x}	Ae^{5x}
8. $(9x - 2)e^{5x}$	$(Ax + B)e^{5x}$
9. x^2e^{5x}	$(Ax^2 + Bx + C)e^{5x}$
10. $e^{3x} \sin 4x$	$Ae^{3x} \cos 4x + Be^{3x} \sin 4x$
11. $5x^2 \sin 4x$	$(Ax^2 + Bx + C) \cos 4x + (Ex^2 + Fx + G) \sin 4x$
12. $xe^{3x} \cos 4x$	$(Ax + B)e^{3x} \cos 4x + (Cx + E)e^{3x} \sin 4x$

- Finally, the general solution is obtained from the **superposition** of y_h and y_p

Example Solve $y'' + 4y = x \cos x$

- If $g(x)$ consists of a sum of, say, m terms of the kind listed in the table, then the assumption for a particular solution y_p consists of the sum of the trial forms
- If y_p contains terms that duplicate terms in y_h, then that y_p must be multiplied by x^n, where n is the smallest positive integer that eliminate that duplication

Example Solve $y'' - 6y' + 9y = 6x^2 + 2 - 12e^{3x}$

Example Solve $y^{(4)} + y''' = 1 - x^2e^{-x}$

Example Solve the given differential equation by undetermined coefficients

- $y'' + 2y' + y = \sin x + 3 \cos 2x$
- $y'' + 2y' - 24y = 16 - (x + 2)e^{4x}$
- $y''' - 6y'' = 3 - \cos x$

Example Solve the given initial-value problem

- $y'' + 4y = -2, \;\; y(\pi/8) = 1/2, \;\; y'(\pi/8) = 2$
- $5y'' + y' = -6x, \;\; y(0) = 0, \; y'(0) = -10$
- $\dfrac{d^2x}{dt^2} + \omega^2 x = F_0 \sin \omega t, \;\; x(0) = 0, \; x'(0) = 0$

3.5 Variation of Parameters

The **method of variation of parameters** can be used with linear higher-order DEs

- This method *always* yields a y_p provided the homogeneous equation can be solved
- This method is not limited to the types of input functions constraining the method of undetermined coefficients

To adapt the method of variation of parameters to a linear second-order DE

$$a_2(x)y'' + a_1(x)y' + a_0(x)y = g(x),$$

we put the above equation in the standard form

$$y'' + P(x)y' + Q(x)y = f(x)$$

To solve,

- Find the homogeneous solutions y_1, y_2
- Seek a particular solution of the form

$$y_p = u_1(x)y_1 + u_2(x)y_2$$

$$y_p'' + P(x)y_p' + Q(x)y_p = f(x)$$

$$\Downarrow\ y_p = u_1y_1 + u_2y_2$$

$$\frac{d}{dx}[y_1u_1' + y_2u_2'] + P(x)[y_1u_1' + y_2u_2'] + y_1'u_1' + y_2'u_2' = f(x)$$

$$\Downarrow \text{ let } y_1u_1' + y_2u_2' = 0, \text{ then } y_1'u_1' + y_2'u_2' = f(x)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} y_1 & y_2 \\ y_1' & y_2' \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} u_1' \\ u_2' \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ f(x) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$u_1 = \int \frac{W_1}{W}\,dx = -\int \frac{y_2}{W}\,f(x)\,dx, \quad u_2 = \int \frac{W_2}{W}\,dx = \int \frac{y_1}{W}\,f(x)\,dx$$

$$\text{where } W = \begin{vmatrix} y_1 & y_2 \\ y_1' & y_2' \end{vmatrix}, \ W_1 = \begin{vmatrix} 0 & y_2 \\ f(x) & y_2' \end{vmatrix}, \ W_2 = \begin{vmatrix} y_1 & 0 \\ y_1' & f(x) \end{vmatrix}$$

Example Solve $y'' - y = \dfrac{1}{x}$

The method can be generalized to the standard form of nth order linear DE. A particular solution is

$$y_p = u_1(x)y_1 + u_2(x)y_2 + \cdots + u_n(x)y_n$$

where

$$u_k = \int \frac{W_k}{W}\,dx, \ k = 1, 2, \cdots, n$$

Example Solve each differential equation by variation of parameters

- $y'' + y = \sec x$
- $y'' + y = \sin x$
- $y'' + y = \cos^2 x$
- $3y'' - 6y' + 6y = e^x \sec x$

Example Solve each differential equation by variation of parameters subject to the initial conditions $y(0) = 1,\ y'(0) = 0$

- $4y'' - y = xe^{x/2}$
- $y'' - 2y' + y = e^x \sec^2 x$
- $y'' + 2y' - 8y = 2e^{-2x} - e^{-x}$

Example Solve each differential equation by variation of parameters subject to the initial conditions $y(0) = 1,\ y'(0) = 0$

- $y'' - 4y = \dfrac{e^{2x}}{x}$
- $2y'' + 2y' + y = 4\sqrt{x}$

3.6 Cauchy-Euler Equation

The **Cauchy-Euler equation** is a linear DE of the form

$$a_n x^n \frac{d^n y}{dx^n} + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} \frac{d^{n-1} y}{dx^{n-1}} + \cdots + a_1 x \frac{dy}{dx} + a_0 y = g(x)$$

where $a_n, a_{n-1}, \cdots, a_0$ are constants and the exponent of the coefficient matches the order of differentiation

$y = x^p$ is a solution of second order Cauchy-Euler equation whenever p is a solution of the **auxiliary equation**

$$a_2 p^2 + (a_1 - a_2)p + a_0 = 0$$

- **Case I:** Distinct Real Roots, p_1, p_2

$$y = c_1 x^{p_1} + c_2 x^{p_2}$$

- **Case II:** Repeated Real Roots, $p_1 = p_2$

$$y = c_1 x^{p_1} + c_2 x^{p_1} \ln x$$

- **Case III:** Complex Conjugate Roots, $p_1, p_2 = \alpha \pm i\beta$

$$y = x^{\alpha}\left[c_1\cos(\beta \ln x) + c_2\sin(\beta \ln x)\right]$$

Example Solve $x^2y'' - 3xy' + 3y = 2x^4e^x$

Example Solve the given differential equation

- $x^2y'' - 2y = 0$
- $xy'' + y' = 0$
- $x^2y'' + xy' + 4y = 0$

Example Solve the given differential equation by variation of parameters

- $xy'' - 4y' = x^4$
- $x^2y'' + xy' - y = \ln x$

3.7 Nonlinear Equations

- Nonlinear equations do not possess superposability

Example Verify that y_1 and y_2 are solutions of the given DE but that $c_1y_1 + c_2y_2$ is, in general, not a solution

$$(y'')^2 = y^2,\ y_1 = e^x,\ y_2 = \cos x$$

- The major difference between linear and nonlinear DEs of order two or higher lies in the realm of solvability. Nonlinear higher-order DEs virtually defy solution. This means that there are no analytical methods whereby either an explicit or implicit solution can be found

- There are still things that can be done; we can always analyze a nonlinear DE qualitatively and numerically
- Nonlinear second-order DE $F(y, y', y'') = 0$ can be reduced to two first-order equations by means of the substitution $u = y'$ and can sometimes be solved using first-order methods

Example Solve $y'' = 2x(y')^2$ and $yy'' = (y')^2$

- In some instances, a solution of a nonlinear IVP can be approximated by a Taylor series centered at x_0

Example Solve $y'' = x + y - y^2,\ y(0) = -1,\ y'(0) = 1$ by using

$$y(x) = y(0) + \frac{y'(0)}{1!}x + \frac{y''(0)}{2!}x^2 + \frac{y'''(0)}{3!}x^3 + \cdots$$

Example The dependent variable y is missing in the given differential equation. Solve the equation by using the substitution $u = y'$

$$y'' + (y')^2 + 1 = 0$$

Example The independent variable x is missing in the given differential equation. Solve the equation by using the substitution $u = y'$

$$yy'' + (y')^2 + 1 = 0$$

Example Consider the initial-value problem

$$y'' + yy' = 0,\ \ y(0) = 1,\ y'(0) = -1$$

1. Use the DE and a numerical solver to graph the solution curve
2. Find an explicit solution of the IVP. Use a graphing utility to graph this solution
3. Find an interval of definition for the solution in part 2

Example Show that the substitution $u = y'$ leads to a Bernoulli equation. Solve this equation

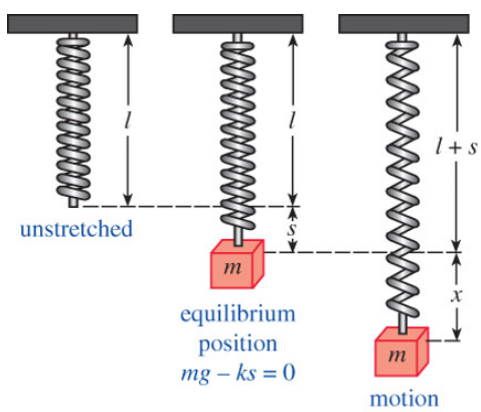
$$xy'' = y' + (y')^3$$

3.8 Linear Models: Initial-Value Problems

Several dynamical systems are modeled with linear 2nd-order DEs with constant coefficients and initial conditions at t_0

- Spring/Mass Systems
  - Free Undamped Motion
  - Free Damped Motion
  - Driven Motion

$$\begin{aligned} m\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} &= -kx - \beta\frac{dx}{dt} + f(t) \\ x(0) &= x_0 \\ \dot{x}(0) &= x_1 \end{aligned}$$



Example Show that the solution of the initial-value problem

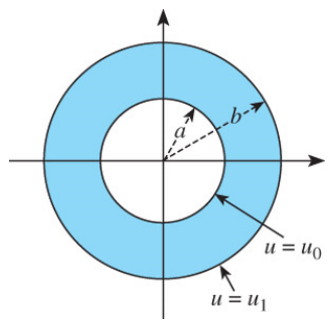
$$\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} + \omega^2 x = F_0 \cos\gamma t,\ x(0) = 0,\ x'(0) = 0$$

is $x(t) = \dfrac{F_0}{\omega^2 - \gamma^2}(\cos\gamma t - \cos\omega t)$

Example Evaluate $\lim\limits_{\gamma\to\omega} \dfrac{F_0}{\omega^2 - \gamma^2}(\cos\gamma t - \cos\omega t)$

3.9 Linear Models: Boundary-Value Problems

Example Temperature in a Ring



The temperature $u(r)$ in circular ring is determined from the boundary-value problem

$$r\frac{d^2u}{dr^2} + \frac{du}{dr} = 0,\ u(a) = u_0,\ u(b) = u_1$$

3.10 Green's Functions

3.10.1 Influence Function

- We shall consider the self-adjoint form

$$\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{du}{dx}\right] + q(x)u = -f(x) \tag{SA}$$

The function $p(x)$ is continuously differentiable and positive, and $q(x)$ and $f(x)$ are continuous for $\alpha < x < \beta$

- The homogeneous second-order differential equation

$$\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{dv}{dx}\right] + q(x)v = 0 \tag{SH}$$

has exactly two linearly independent solutions $v_1(x)$ and $v_2(x)$: any solution of (SH) can be written in the form

$$v(x) = c_1 v_1(x) + c_2 v_2(x)$$

where c_1 and c_2 are constants

- We now consider the function

$$w(x) = v_1(x)\int_\alpha^x v_2(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi - v_2(x)\int_\alpha^x v_1(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi$$

Differentiating w, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dw}{dx} &= v_1'(x)\int_\alpha^x v_2(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi - v_2'(x)\int_\alpha^x v_1(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi + \underbrace{[v_1(x)v_2(x) - v_2(x)v_1(x)]}_{=0} f(x)\\ &= v_1'(x)\int_\alpha^x v_2(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi - v_2'(x)\int_\alpha^x v_1(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi\end{aligned}$$

- Then

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{dw}{dx}\right] &= \underbrace{\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)v_1'(x)\right]}_{-q(x)v_1}\int_\alpha^x v_2(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi - \underbrace{\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)v_2'(x)\right]}_{-q(x)v_2}\int_\alpha^x v_1(\xi)f(\xi)\,d\xi\\ &\quad + \underbrace{p(x)\left[v_1'(x)v_2(x) - v_2'(x)v_1(x)\right]}_{-K} f(x)\\ &= -q(x)w - Kf(x)\end{aligned}$$

where

$$
\begin{aligned}
&\frac{d}{dx}\left\{p(x)\left[v_1'(x)v_2(x)-v_2'(x)v_1(x)\right]\right\}\\
&\quad=\underbrace{\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)v_1'(x)\right]}_{-q(x)v_1(x)}v_2(x)-\underbrace{\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)v_2'(x)\right]}_{-q(x)v_2(x)}v_1(x)+p(x)v_1'(x)v_2'(x)-p(x)v_2'(x)v_1'(x)=0\\
&\quad\Downarrow\\
&\quad K \text{ is constant}
\end{aligned}
$$

- We have shown that w satisfies the equation:

$$\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{dw}{dx}\right]+q(x)w=-Kf(x)$$

Moreover, as $x\to\alpha$

$$w(\alpha)=w'(\alpha)=0$$

- Dividing by the constant K, we find that the function

$$u(x)=\int_\alpha^x R(x,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi \tag{IN}$$

where

$$R(x,\xi)=\frac{v_1(x)v_2(\xi)-v_2(x)v_1(\xi)}{K}=-\frac{v_1(x)v_2(\xi)-v_2(x)v_1(\xi)}{p(x)\left[v_1'(x)v_2(x)-v_2'(x)v_1(x)\right]}$$

is the solution of the initial value problem

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{du}{dx}\right]+qu&=-f(x)\quad\text{for } x>\alpha\\ u(\alpha)=u'(\alpha)&=0\end{aligned}$$

- Since the denominator of $R(x,\xi)$ is a constant, the function $R(x,\xi)$ satisfies the homogeneous equation (SH) as either a function of x or ξ. In fact,

$$R(x,\xi)=-R(\xi,x)$$

- For a fixed value of ξ, $R(x,\xi)$ is completely characterized as the solution of the homogeneous initial value problem

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{dR}{dx}\right] + q(x)R = 0 \quad \text{for } x > \xi \\ R\big|_{x=\xi} = 0 \\ R'\big|_{x=\xi} = -\frac{1}{p(\xi)} \end{aligned}$$

- The function $R(x,\xi)$ describes the influence on the value of u at x of a disturbance(impulse) concentrated at ξ. It is sometimes called the **influence function**, or the one-sided Green's function
- If the values of $u(\alpha)$ and $u'(\alpha)$ are prescribed to be other than zero, we must simply add a suitable solution $c_1v_1(x) + c_2v_2(x)$ to the expression (IN)

Example Consider the problem

$$\begin{aligned} u'' + u = -f(x) \quad \text{for } x > 0 \\ u(0) = 1 \\ u'(0) = -1 \end{aligned}$$

Solution $u(x) = w(x) + v(x)$

(1) $w(x)$

$$\begin{aligned} w'' + w = -f(x) \quad \text{for } x > 0 \\ w(0) = 0 \\ w'(0) = 0 \end{aligned}$$

For a fixed value of ξ, the influence function $R(x,\xi)$ satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d^2R}{dx^2} + R = 0 \quad \text{for } x > \xi \\ R\big|_{x=\xi} = 0 \\ R'\big|_{x=\xi} = -1 \end{aligned}$$

Thus $R(x,\xi) = \sin(\xi - x)$ and the solution is

$$w(x) = \int_0^x \sin(\xi - x)\, f(\xi)\, d\xi$$

(2) $v(x)$

$$\begin{aligned} v'' + v &= 0 \quad \text{for } \ x > 0 \\ v(0) &= 1 \\ v'(0) &= -1 \end{aligned}$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$v(x) = \cos x - \sin x$$

3.10.2 Green's Function

- Here, we research a two-point boundary value problem:

$$\begin{gathered} \frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{du}{dx}\right] + q(x)u = -f(x) \quad \text{for } \alpha < x < \beta \\ u(\alpha) = u(\beta) = 0 \end{gathered} \tag{P1}$$

  Writing the general solution in the form

$$u(x) = \int_\alpha^x R(x,\xi)\, f(\xi)\, d\xi + c_1 v_1(x) + c_2 v_2(x)$$

  we obtain the two equations

$$\begin{aligned} c_1 v_1(\alpha) + c_2 v_2(\alpha) &= 0 \\ c_1 v_1(\beta) + c_2 v_2(\beta) &= -\int_\alpha^\beta R(\beta,\xi)\, f(\xi)\, d\xi \end{aligned}$$

  These two equations determine a unique pair of constants c_1 and c_2, provided the determinant of their coefficients is not zero; that is, provided

$$D \equiv v_1(\alpha)v_2(\beta) - v_2(\alpha)v_1(\beta) \neq 0$$

- We assume this for the moment. Then

$$
\begin{aligned}
c_1 &= \frac{v_2(\alpha)}{D}\int_\alpha^\beta R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi \\
&= \frac{v_2(\alpha)}{D}\int_\alpha^x R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi + \frac{v_2(\alpha)}{D}\int_x^\beta R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi \\
c_2 &= -\frac{v_1(\alpha)}{D}\int_\alpha^\beta R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi \\
&= -\frac{v_1(\alpha)}{D}\int_\alpha^x R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi - \frac{v_1(\alpha)}{D}\int_x^\beta R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi
\end{aligned}
$$

- The solution can then be written as

$$
\begin{aligned}
u(x) = &\int_\alpha^x \left[R(x,\xi) + \frac{v_2(\alpha)v_1(x) - v_1(\alpha)v_2(x)}{D}R(\beta,\xi)\right] f(\xi)\,d\xi \\
&+ \int_x^\beta \frac{v_2(\alpha)v_1(x) - v_1(\alpha)v_2(x)}{D}R(\beta,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi
\end{aligned}
$$

- We find after some algebraic manipulation that

$$
\begin{aligned}
G(x,\xi) &= R(x,\xi) + \frac{v_2(\alpha)v_1(x) - v_1(\alpha)v_2(x)}{D}R(\beta,\xi) \\
&= \frac{v_1(x)v_2(\xi) - v_2(x)v_1(\xi)}{K}\frac{D}{D} + \frac{v_2(\alpha)v_1(x) - v_1(\alpha)v_2(x)}{D}\frac{v_1(\beta)v_2(\xi) - v_2(\beta)v_1(\xi)}{K} \\
&= \frac{[v_1(\alpha)v_2(\xi) - v_2(\alpha)v_1(\xi)]\,[v_1(x)v_2(\beta) - v_2(x)v_1(\beta)]}{KD} \quad \text{for } \xi \le x
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
G(x,\xi) &= \frac{v_2(\alpha)v_1(x) - v_1(\alpha)v_2(x)}{D}R(\beta,\xi) \\
&= \frac{[v_1(x)v_2(\alpha) - v_2(x)v_1(\alpha)]\,[v_1(\beta)v_2(\xi) - v_2(\beta)v_1(\xi)]}{KD} \quad \text{for } \xi \ge x
\end{aligned}
$$

- Then the solution of the two-point boundary value problem (P1) can be written in the form

$$
u(x) = \int_\alpha^\beta G(x,\xi)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi \tag{GR}
$$

- The function $G(x,\xi)$ is called the **Green's function** of the problem (P1). It is symmetric. That is

$$
G(x,\xi) = G(\xi,x)
$$

- To determine the Green's function, we note that for each ξ it satisfies the following boundary value problem

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{dG}{dx}\right] + q(x)G &= 0 \quad \text{for } x \neq \xi \\
G\big|_{x=\alpha} = G\big|_{x=\beta} &= 0 \\
G\big|_{x=\xi+0} - G\big|_{x=\xi-0} &= 0 \\
G'\big|_{x=\xi+0} - G'\big|_{x=\xi-0} &= -\frac{1}{p(\xi)}
\end{aligned}$$

Example Consider the problem

$$\begin{aligned}
u'' &= -f(x) \quad \text{for } 0 < x < 1 \\
u(0) &= 0 \\
u(1) &= 0
\end{aligned}$$

Solution

$$\begin{aligned}
G'' = 0 \;&\Rightarrow\; G = ax + b \\
&\Downarrow\; {\scriptstyle G|_{x=0}=G|_{x=1}=0} \\
G(x,\xi) &= \begin{cases} a_1(\xi)\,x & \text{for } x < \xi \\ a_2(\xi)(1-x) & \text{for } x > \xi \end{cases} \\
&\Downarrow\; {\scriptstyle G(x,\xi)=G(\xi,x)} \\
a_1(\xi) &= A(1-\xi) \\
a_2(\xi) &= A\xi \\
&\Downarrow\; {\scriptstyle G'|_{x=\xi+0}-G'|_{x=\xi-0}=-1} \\
-A\xi - A(1-\xi) &= -1 \to A = 1 \\
&\Downarrow \\
G(x,\xi) &= \begin{cases} (1-\xi)x & \text{for } x \leq \xi \\ \xi(1-x) & \text{for } x \geq \xi \end{cases}
\end{aligned}$$

The solution is

$$u(x) = \int_0^x \xi(1-x)\,f(\xi)\,d\xi + \int_x^1 (1-\xi)x\,f(\xi)\,d\xi$$

- Two-point boundary value problems with more general boundary conditions can be treated in the same manner. We consider the problem

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{du}{dx}\right] + q(x)u &= -f(x) \quad \text{for } \alpha < x < \beta \\ -\mu_1 u'(\alpha) + \sigma_1 u(\alpha) &= 0 \\ \mu_2 u'(\beta) + \sigma_2 u(\beta) &= 0 \end{aligned} \tag{P2}$$

- The Green's function $G(x,\xi)$ is derived as before, provided the condition

$$\begin{aligned} D \equiv & \left[-\mu_1 v_1'(\alpha) + \sigma_1 v_1(\alpha)\right]\left[\mu_2 v_2'(\beta) + \sigma_2 v_2(\beta)\right] \\ & - \left[-\mu_1 v_2'(\alpha) + \sigma_1 v_2(\alpha)\right]\left[\mu_2 v_1'(\beta) + \sigma_2 v_1(\beta)\right] \neq 0 \end{aligned}$$

  is satisfied

- The Green's function $G(x,\xi)$ is the solution of the problem

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dx}\left[p(x)\frac{dG}{dx}\right] + q(x)G &= 0 \quad \text{for } x \neq \xi \\ -\mu_1\, G'\big|_{x=\alpha} + \sigma_1\, G\big|_{x=\alpha} = \mu_2\, G'\big|_{x=\beta} + \sigma_2\, G\big|_{x=\beta} &= 0 \\ G\big|_{x=\xi+0} - G\big|_{x=\xi-0} &= 0 \\ G'\big|_{x=\xi+0} - G'\big|_{x=\xi-0} &= -\frac{1}{p(\xi)} \end{aligned}$$

  It still satisfies the symmetry relation

$$G(x,\xi) = G(\xi,x)$$

Example Consider the problem

$$\begin{aligned} u'' &= -f(x) \quad \text{for } 0 < x < 1 \\ u(0) &= 0 \\ u'(1) + \sigma_2 u(1) &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

Solution $u(x) = w(x) + v(x)$

(1) $w(x)$

$$
\begin{aligned}
w'' &= -f(x) \quad \text{for } 0 < x < 1 \\
w(0) &= 0 \\
w'(1) + \sigma_2 w(1) &= 0
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
G'' &= 0 \\
&\Downarrow \\
G &= ax + b \\
&\Downarrow \; G|_{x=0} = G'|_{x=1} + \sigma_2 G|_{x=1} = 0 \\
G(x,\xi) &= \begin{cases} a_1(\xi)\, x & \text{for } x < \xi \\ a_2(\xi)\,[1 + \sigma_2(1-x)] & \text{for } x > \xi \end{cases} \\
&\Downarrow \; G(x,\xi) = G(\xi,x) \\
a_1(\xi) &= A\,[1 + \sigma_2(1-\xi)] \\
a_2(\xi) &= A\xi \\
&\Downarrow \; G'|_{x=\xi+0} - G'|_{x=\xi-0} = -1 \\
A\xi \cdot -\sigma_2 - A\,[1 + \sigma_2(1-\xi)] &= -1 \to A = \frac{1}{1+\sigma_2} \\
&\Downarrow \\
G(x,\xi) &= \begin{cases} \frac{[1+\sigma_2(1-\xi)]\,x}{1+\sigma_2} & \text{for } x \le \xi \\ \frac{\xi\,[1+\sigma_2(1-x)]}{1+\sigma_2} & \text{for } x \ge \xi \end{cases}
\end{aligned}
$$

The solution is

$$
w(x) = \int_0^x \frac{\xi\,[1 + \sigma_2(1-x)]}{1+\sigma_2}\, f(\xi)\, d\xi + \int_x^1 \frac{[1 + \sigma_2(1-\xi)]\; x}{1+\sigma_2}\, f(\xi)\, d\xi
$$

(2) $v(x)$

$$
\begin{aligned}
v'' &= 0 \quad \text{for } \; 0 < x < 1 \\
v(0) &= 0 \\
v'(1) + \sigma_2 v(1) &= 1
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\Downarrow
$$

$$
v(x) = \frac{x}{1+\sigma_2}
$$

Example Consider the problem

$$r^2u'' + 2ru' - n(n+1)u = -r^2F(r),\ u(R) = 0,\ u \sim \text{bounded}$$

Solution

$$\frac{d}{dr}\left[r^2\frac{dG}{dr}\right] - n(n+1)G = 0$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$G = c_1r^n + c_2r^{-(n+1)}$$

$$\Downarrow G|_{r=0} = \text{bounded}\ ,\ G|_{r=R} = 0$$

$$G(r,\rho) = \begin{cases} a_1(\rho)r^n & \text{for } r < \rho \\ a_2(\rho)\left[\left(\frac{r}{R}\right)^{-(n+1)} - \left(\frac{r}{R}\right)^n\right] & \text{for } r > \rho \end{cases}$$

$$\Downarrow G(r,\rho) = G(\rho,r)$$

$$a_1(\rho) = A\left[\left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^{-(n+1)} - \left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^n\right]$$

$$a_2(\rho) = A\rho^n$$

$$\Downarrow G'|_{r=\rho+0} - G'|_{r=\rho-0} = -1/\rho^2$$

$$\frac{A\rho^n}{R}\left[-(n+1)\left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^{-(n+2)} - n\left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^{n-1}\right] - An\rho^{n-1}\left[\left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^{-(n+1)} - \left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^n\right] = -\frac{1}{\rho^2} \quad \rightarrow \quad A = \frac{1}{(2n+1)R^{n+1}}$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$G(r,\rho) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{(2n+1)R}\left(\frac{r}{R}\right)^n\left[\left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^{-(n+1)} - \left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^n\right] & \text{for } r \le \rho \\ \frac{1}{(2n+1)R}\left(\frac{\rho}{R}\right)^n\left[\left(\frac{r}{R}\right)^{-(n+1)} - \left(\frac{r}{R}\right)^n\right] & \text{for } r \ge \rho \end{cases}$$

The solution is

$$u(x) = \int_0^R G(r,\rho)\,F(\rho)\rho^2 d\rho$$

3.11 Solving Nonlinear Model

- In order to analyze an nth order IVP numerically, we express the nth order ODE as a system of n first-order equations

- For example,

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = f(x, y, y'), \;\; y(x_0) = y_0, \; y'(x_0) = y_1$$

$$\Downarrow y' = u$$

$$\text{Solve}: \begin{cases} y' = u \\ u' = f(x, y, u) \end{cases}$$

$$\text{subject to}: y(x_0) = y_0, \; u(x_0) = y_1$$

Example Use a numerical solver to obtain the solution curves satisfying the given initial conditions:

$$\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} + \frac{dx}{dt} + x + x^3 = 0$$

$$x(0) = -3, \; \dot{x}(0) = 4, \;\; \text{or} \;\; x(0) = 0, \; \dot{x}(0) = -8$$

Solution

$$\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} + \frac{dx}{dt} = -x - x^3$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$\dot{x} = u$$

$$\dot{u} = -x - x^3 - u$$

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.integrate import solve_ivp

def func(t, y):
    return [y[1], -y[0] -y[0]**3 -y[1]]

tf = 14
t_eval = np.linspace(0, tf, 200)

sol1 = solve_ivp(func, [0, tf], [-3, 4], t_eval=t_eval)
sol2 = solve_ivp(func, [0, tf], [0, -8], t_eval=t_eval)
```

```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
plt.style.use('ggplot')

plt.figure(figsize=(6, 4))

plt.plot(sol1.t, sol1.y[0], 'b-', label=r'$x_0=-3,\; \dot{x}_0=4$')
plt.plot(sol2.t, sol2.y[0], 'r-', label=r'$x_0=0,\; \dot{x}_0=-8$')
plt.axis((0, tf, -3, 3))
plt.xlabel('t')
plt.ylabel('x')
plt.legend()

plt.show()
```

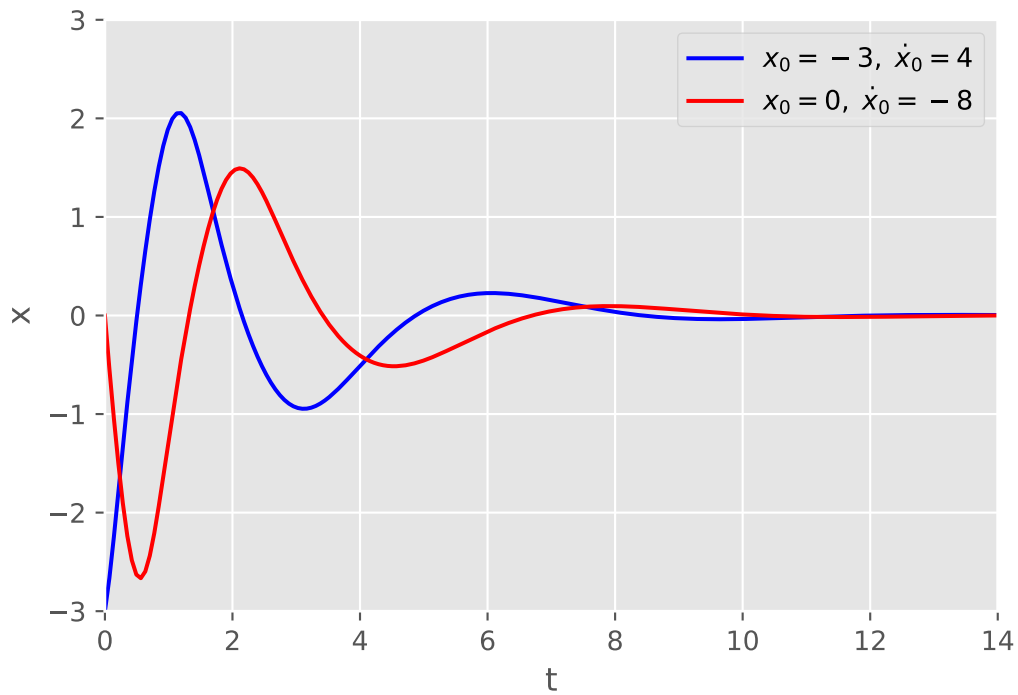
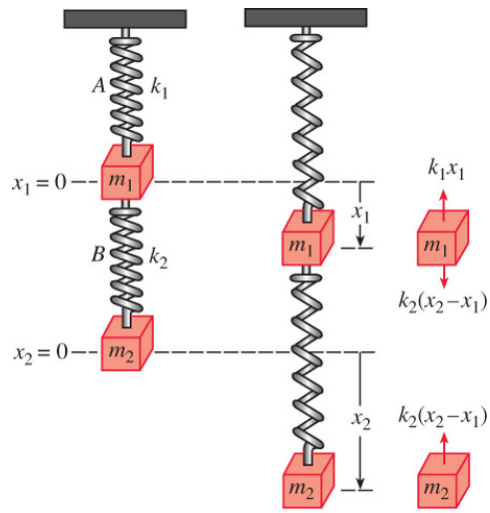


Figure 3.1: $\dfrac{d^2x}{dt^2} + \dfrac{dx}{dt} + x + x^3 = 0$

3.12 Solving System of Linear Equations

When physical systems are coupled, the mathematical model of the system usually consists of a set of coupled DEs



$$
\begin{aligned}
m_1\ddot{x}_1 &= -k_1x_1 + k_2(x_2 - x_1) \\
m_2\ddot{x}_2 &= -k_2(x_2 - x_1)
\end{aligned}
$$

Linear systems with constant coefficients can be solved by uncoupling the system into distinct linear ODEs in each dependent variable

Example Solve the above equation under the assumption that $k_1 = 6$, $k_2 = 4$, $m_1 = 1$, and $m_2 = 1$ subject to

$$x_1(0) = 0,\ x_1'(0) = 1,\ x_2(0) = 0,\ x_2'(0) = -1$$

```
k1, k2, m1, m2 = 6, 4, 1, 1

def func(t, y):
    return [y[1], -(k1 + k2)/m1 * y[0] + k2/m1 * y[2],
            y[3], k2/m2 * y[0] - k2/m2 * y[2]]

tf = 14
t_eval = np.linspace(0, tf, 200)
```

```
sol = solve_ivp(func, [0, tf], [0, 1, 0, -1], t_eval=t_eval)
```

```
plt.figure(figsize=(6, 4))

plt.plot(sol.t, sol.y[0], 'b-', label='$x_1$')
plt.plot(sol.t, sol.y[2], 'r-', label='$x_2$')
plt.axis((0, tf, -0.6, 0.6))
plt.legend()
plt.xlabel('t')
plt.ylabel('x')

plt.show()
```

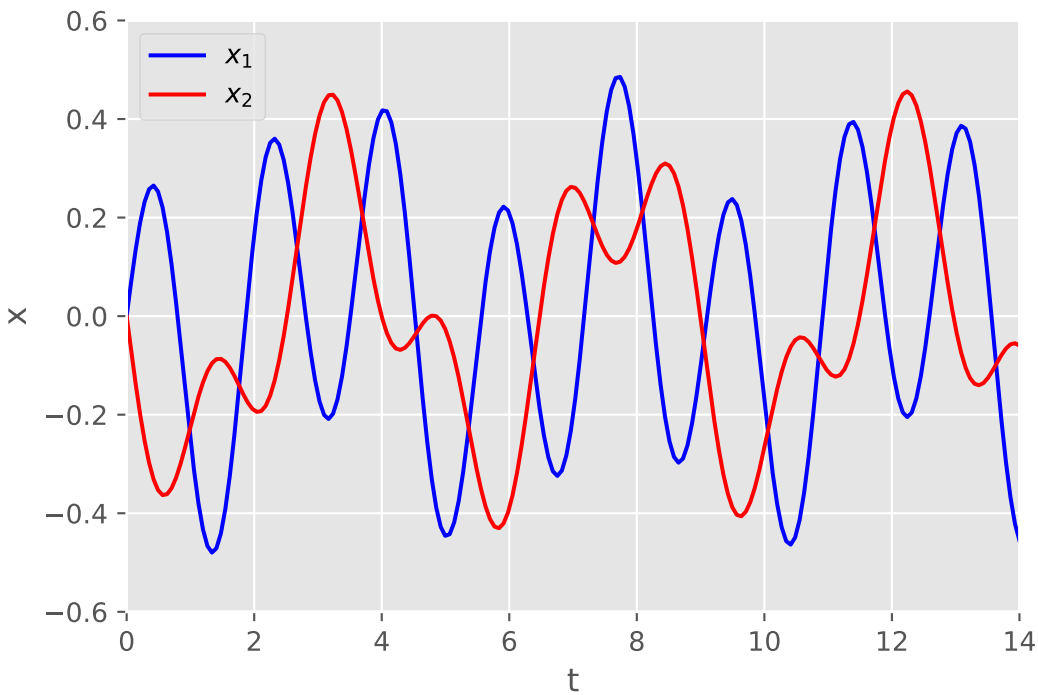


Figure 3.2: Coupled Spring/Mass System